

C Programming

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COMMAND LINE ARGUMENTS

It is possible to pass arguments to C programs when they are executed. The brackets which follow `main` are used for this purpose. `argc` refers to the number of arguments passed, and `argv[]` is a pointer array which points to each argument which is passed to `main`. A simple example follows, which checks to see if a single argument is supplied on the command line when the program is invoked.

```
#include <stdio.h>

main( int argc, char *argv[] )
{
    if( argc == 2 )
        printf("The argument supplied is %s\n", argv[1]);
    else if( argc > 2 )
        printf("Too many arguments supplied.\n");
    else
        printf("One argument expected.\n");
}
```

Note that `*argv[0]` is the name of the program invoked, which means that `*argv[1]` is a pointer to the first argument supplied, and `*argv[n]` is the last argument. If no arguments are supplied, `argc` will be one. Thus for `n` arguments, `argc` will be equal to `n + 1`. The program is called by the command line,

```
myprog argument1
```

EXERCISE C27

Rewrite the program which copies files, ie, `FCOPY.C` to accept the source and destination filenames from the command line. Include a check on the number of arguments passed.

[Answer](#)

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